MILTIARY SPECIFICATION

HOLDER, SUTURE NEEDLE, COLLIER

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers one size of suture needle holder, Collier design, suitable for securely holding suture needles.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

GG-I-526	- Instruments, Dental and Surgical; General Specifications.
PPP-B-566	- Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-585	- Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601	- Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	- Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	- Boxes, Set-Up.

MILITARY

MIL-P-116	- Preservation-Packaging, Methods of.
MIL-L-10547	- Liner, Case, And Sheet, Overwrap: Water Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Headquarters, Defense Personnel Support Center, ATTN: Directorate of Medical Materiel, DPSC-ATT, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document, or by letter.

FSC 6515

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-151 - Metal, Test Methods.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications, standards, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM) STANDARDS

E-10 Method of Test for Brinell Hardness of Metallic Materials.
E-18 Rockwell Hardness and Rockwell Superficial Hardness of Metallic Materials.
E-92 Method of Test for Vickers Hardness of Metallic Materials.
E-140 Standard Hardness Conversion Tables for Metals.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 General requirements. The individual part requirements shall be as specified herein and in accordance with the applicable requirements of GG-I-526 In the event of any conflict between the requirements of GG-I-526 and those of this specifications, the latter shall govern.

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3.2 Material. The suture needle holder shall be fabricated from AISI Type 410 or AISI Type 420 stainless steel as specified in GG-I-526.

3.3 Design and construction. The instrument shall be a suture needle holder of the Collier design having a nominal overall length of 5 inches. It shall be designed to have a box type lock and handle with finger rings and ratchet type closure. The shanks of the instrument shall terminate with fenestrated jaws having straight serrations suitable for secure and accurate retention of suture needles near the tip of the jaws.

3.3.1 Physical dimensions. The physical dimensions of the instrument shall be in accordance with figure 1.

3.3.2 Hardness. When tested as specified in 4.5.1, the finished instrument shall have a Rockwell hardness of C40 to C45, after proper stress relieving.

3.3.3 Corrosion resistance. The instrument shall be corrosion resistant conforming with the requirements of GG-I-526 when tested as specified in 4.5.2.1 and 4.5.2.2.

3.3.4 Lock stiffness. The shanks of instruments shall fall freely conforming with the requirements of GG-I-526 when tested as specified in 4.5.3.

3.3.5 Jaw and ratchet operation. When tested as specified in 4.5.4, the jaw tips shall close first and progressively tighten with each ratchet position. Each ratchet position shall hold firmly and release instantly.

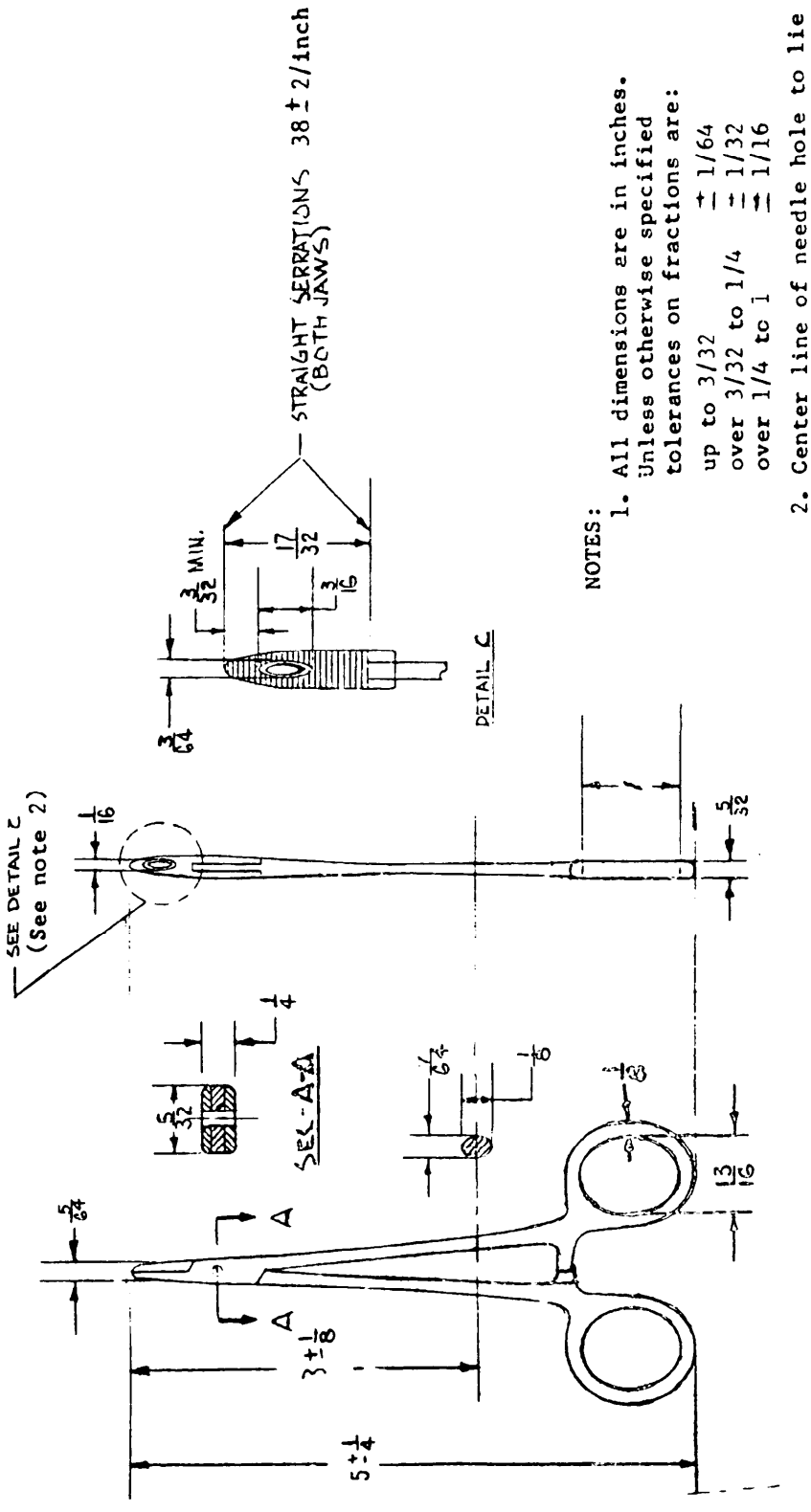
3.3.6 Needle retention. When tested as specified in 4.5.5, the needle holder shall securely and accurately retain suture needles.

3.4 Finish. The finished instrument shall have a mirror or matte finish as specified in GG-I-526.

3.4.1 Passivation. As a final finish operation, the complete instrument shall be passivated.

3.5 Identification marking. Identification marking of finished instruments shall be in accordance with GG-I-526. In addition to the requirements specified, instruments of foreign manufacture shall also be marked "stainless".

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NOTES:

1. All dimensions are in inches. Unless otherwise specified tolerances on fractions are:

up to 3/32	± 1/64
over 3/32 to 1/4	± 1/32
over 1/4 to 1	± 1/16

2. Center line of needle hole to lie along center line of jaws.

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3.6 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. The instrument shall be processed in such a manner as to be uniform in quality and shall be free from surface roughness, burrs, pits, scale, corrosion, or any other defect that will affect life, serviceability or appearance.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual, and auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality supplied by the manufacturer of the corrosion resistant metals may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the National Stock Number (NSN), the item identification, the name of the component and/or material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Inspection lot. The inspection lot shall be determined in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

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4.2.2 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as indicated in table I. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one needle holder.

TABLE I. Sampling criteria for examination.

Type of defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major	II	1.0
Minor A	II	4.0
Minor B	S-2	4.0

4.2.3 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as indicated in table II. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one needle holder. Where feasible, the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

TABLE II. Sampling criteria for tests.

Component	Characteristics	Requirement	Test procedure	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Needle holder	Rockwell hardness	3.3.2	4.5.1	S-2	1.5
	Corrosion	3.3.3	4.5.2.1 & 4.5.2.2	S-2	1.0
	Lock stiffness	3.3.4	4.5.3	II	6.5
	Jaw and ratchet operation	3.3.5	4.5.4	S-2	4.0
	Needle retention	3.3.6	4.5.5	S-2	4.0

4.2.4 Raw materials. A sufficient amount from each lot of each metal used in the construction of the instrument shall be selected for chemical analysis.

4.3 Examination for visual and dimensional defects. The needle holder shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification. Examination shall be conducted as specified in tables I and III. Examination, however, shall not be restricted to defects listed in table III. Any instrument in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected and if the number of defective instruments in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by that sample shall be rejected.

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TABLE III. Classification of defects.

tegories	Defects
itical	None defined.
jor	
101	Design not as specified.
102	Instrument not constructed as specified.
103	Instrument not free from sharp edges, rough areas, burrs, cracks, grind marks, pits or overlaps.
104	Serrations not as specified.
105	Ratchet teeth not uniform.
106	Ratchet teeth do not function properly.
107	Holders not free from excessive play in box-lock area.
nor A	
201	Finish not as specified.
202	Instrument not permanently and legibly marked with either the name or trademark of the contractor.
203	Serrations not free of foreign matter.
nor B	
251	Physical dimensions not as specified.

4.4 Packaging inspection. The inspection of the preservation-packaging d interior package marking shall be in accordance with the group A and B ality conformance inspection requirements of MIL-P-116. The inspection of e packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with e quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification d the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

4.5 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with ecification requirements.

4.5.1 Hardness. Rockwell hardness shall be determined in accordance with TM test method E18. Hardness may be determined in accordance with ASTM Method 0 or E92 provided hardness reading is converted to appropriate Rockwell scale ilizing conversion table in ASTM method E140. A minimum of 5 hardness readings all be made on test specimens representative of the material used in the brication of the instrument or on the finished instrument.

4.5.2 Corrosion tests.

4.5.2.1 Boil test. The instrument shall be subjected to the boil test as ecified in GG-I-526.

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4.5.2.2 Copper Sulfate Test. The instrument shall be subjected to the copper sulfate test as specified in GG-I-526.

4.5.3 Lock stiffness test. The instrument shall be subjected to the lock stiffness test as described in GG-I-526.

4.5.4 Jaw and ratchet operation. The instrument shall be positioned to the first ratchet position, but not locked. Instruments with jaw tips not touching shall be rejected. Instruments that do not progressively tighten with each ratchet advance shall be rejected.

4.5.5 Needle retention. The longitudinal axis of a 25 mil (0.025 inches) diameter hardened steel wire having a nominal length of 1 inch shall be held perpendicular to the axis of the jaws, anywhere along the length of the jaw serrations and the third position of the ratchet engaged. Alternatively, the wire specified may be placed on a plane surface. With the ratchet closure disengaged the instrument shall be positioned so that the jaw tips will grasp the wire upon engagement of the ratchets. In either method with the ratchet engaged in the third position and the jaws clamped on the wire, there shall be no visible lateral, rotational or longitudinal movement of the wire nor shall there by any lateral displacement of the jaws. Upon disengagement of the ratchets and removal of the wire, there shall be no visible distortion of the instrument jaws.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation-packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One suture needle holder, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 Level A.

5.1.2.1 Cleaning. Holders shall be cleaned in accordance with MIL-P-116, process C-1.

5.1.2.2 Drying. Holders shall be dried in accordance with MIL-P-116.

5.1.2.3 Preservative application. Preservatives shall not be used.

5.1.2.4 Unit packaging. Each holder shall be packaged in accordance with MIL-P-116, method IC-1.

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5.1.2.5 Intermediate package. Six unit packages shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.1.3 Level C. Holders shall be clean, dry and individually packaged in a manner that will afford adequate protection against corrosion, deterioration and physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Forty-eight intermediate packages (288 units) shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601 overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2 or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.1.1 Case liner. Each Level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall be as specified in the appendix of MIL-L-10547. Case liners shall not be required for fiberboard boxes. Fiberboard boxes shall be waterproofed as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Forty-eight intermediate packages (288 units) shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-585, class 1, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The packaged holders shall be packed in shipping containers in a manner that will afford adequate protection against damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. These packs shall conform to the applicable carrier rules and regulations.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Interior packages. Each unit and intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Contract or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown.

5.3.2 Exterior containers. Exterior containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The suture needle holders of the Collier design are to be used for grasping and holding suture needles during surgical procedures

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and the procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5
(c) National Stock Number.

6.3 This specification is intended to cover the following item appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock Number	Item Identification
6515-00-341-7200	HOLDER, SUTURE, NEEDLE, Collier, 5-inch

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency-DM

Project No. 6515-2060

Review activity:
DOD - MB

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

MIL-H-37654 HOLDER, SUTURE NEEDLE, Collier

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

REMARKS

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